

Wei Hou

Updated September 3, 2026

Contact	Burgemeester Oudlaan 50 Erasmus School of Economics Erasmus University Rotterdam 3062 PA Rotterdam, The Netherlands	Office: E-building E2-42 Phone: +31 (0) 63 976 0299 E-mail: hou@ese.eur.nl Website: https://wei-hou-finance.github.io/
Research interests	Empirical corporate finance, labor-market institutions, corporate governance, firm organization	
Education	School of Economics, Erasmus University	Rotterdam, Netherlands
	Ph.D. in Finance	2023 – 2027 (expected)
	University Carlos III of Madrid (UC3M)	Madrid, Spain
	Mphil in Business and Finance	2021 – 2023
	Tilburg University	Tilburg, Netherlands
Working Paper	Msc in Finance	2019 – 2021
	Nankai University	Tianjin, China
	Bsc in Business Administration	2015 – 2019
Working Paper	On the Program: A Gender Equality Initiative and Professional Visibility at Academic Conferences	
	With Marina Gertsberg, Esad Smajlbegovic, Daniel Urban, and Patrick Verwijmeren.	
	<i>Revise & Resubmit, Research Policy</i>	

Abstract: Persistent gender disparities characterize scientific careers. We study a gender equality initiative implemented at a leading academic conference, a key stage in researchers' careers where visibility, reputation, and professional networks are shaped. Using a difference-in-differences design that compares two major conferences within the same discipline, we show that a time-limited initiative encouraging the appointment of women as paper discussants led to a sharp but temporary increase in female representation in this prestigious role. The increase did not come at the expense of quality: female discussants on the conference program during the initiative had stronger publication records and comparable expertise-paper matches. The initiative increased female representation across the seniority distribution, with the largest gains among senior women, where pre-initiative underrepresentation was most severe. Senior women also took on a disproportionate number of conference roles. Over time, the pool of selected women broadened modestly to include scholars from lower-ranked institutions, and matched evidence is consistent with subsequent recognition gains for both senior and junior women. Our findings show that leadership-driven gender equality initiatives can meaningfully alter representation in high-profile academic roles, but that their effects are not necessarily self-sustaining.

Presentations: ESE Cheapthrills 2024, TU Munich 2025, University of Melbourne 2025, FBA Conference 2025

Noncompete Agreements and Internal Labor Markets

Presentations: Tinbergen Institute Jamboree, ESE Cheap Thrills, Spanish Finance Forum PhD Day, Corporate Finance Day 2026 (scheduled), FMA 2026 (scheduled), and 7th RCF-ECGI Conference (scheduled)

Abstract: This paper studies how labor mobility restrictions shape firms' internal allocation of human capital. Exploiting staggered state-level variation in noncompete agreement (NCA) enforceability and matched employee-level data from Revelio Labs, I show that tighter restrictions increase internal promotions, with effects concentrated among workers in operations- and production-related functions and knowledge workers. Organizational hierarchy also adjusts: small establishments add hierarchical layers and extend career ladders, while large establishments become flatter. At the firm level, NCA-sensitive firms increase assets and SG&A per employee. I provide evidence that hold-up alleviation and internal tournament incentives drive these patterns. Together, the findings show that NCAs reshape the organizational structures through which firms develop and allocate human capital.

Publication

Ranking finance conferences: An update

with Esad Smajlbegovic and Daniel Urban

Journal of Empirical Finance, 2025

Journal Referee	<i>Review of Managerial Science</i>	
Teaching experience	Thesis Supervisor, Department of Business Economics 2024–2027 FEM11067: Master’s Thesis Financial Economics FEB13100: Bachelor Thesis Supervise master’s and bachelor’s theses Teaching Assistant, Department of Business Economics Fall 2024-2027 FEM11118: Advanced Corporate Finance and Governance <i>Average course rating: 8.5/10</i> <i>Average student rating: 4.4/5</i>	
Honors and Awards	National Beca Scholarship-Government of Spain 2021-2022 National Beca Scholarship-Government of Spain 2022-2023 CentER Research Assistance Honors, Tilburg University 2020 University Scholarship, Nankai University 2018	
Presentations	ESE Cheapthrills, ESE Research Retreat 2024 Seminars at University of Melbourne, Tinbergen Jamboree Seminar, TU Munich 2025, FBA Conference 2025, ESE Research Retreat PhD Seminars at RSM, PhD Workshop at 33rd Spanish Finance Forum, Tinbergen Jamboree Seminar, ESE Cheapthrills, 23rd Benelux Corporate Finance Days, 7th RCF-ECGI, FMA 2026 2026	
Skills	Programming Proficient in: R, Stata, LaTeX, Python. Languages Mandarin (native), English (proficient)	
Other interests	Snowboard, Tennis, Cycling, and Hiking	